

still use wired printers, the system is still experimental. The OS supports CUPS to enable printing through some USB printers. As mentioned before, Chrome OS is based on Linux, specifically the monolithic variant. And it works on x86 and ARMv7 processor architectures.

Software

Apart from the web browser, the OS also features a media player, file manager, applications and a taskbar. The media players support all the formats that Chrome browser does. The list includes Microsoft office formats, .avi, .mov, .mp4, .mp3, .mkv, .gif, .jpg, .png, .zip, .rar, .txt, .pdf and more. The in-built photo viewer app provides basic photoediting capabilities, but don't expect high-level, Photoshop-like photo retouching. Storage can be managed through the provided file manager. It merges all internal, external and cloud storage under one umbrella. Now because the OS is designed to work with web applications, dependence on cloud storage is heavy here. You only get a small amount of local storage with the ability to plug in external storage. But really, if you buy this device, it's because of the cloud. And we don't just mean Google Drive, but other web applications and their cloud capabilities as well.

Initially, when the OS was launched only applications from the Chrome store were supported. Google even pushed the concept of specific Chrome OS applications, which are much more capable than standard web applications. Eventually Google released the Play Store for the OS and in a single swoop made the OS deeper in terms of applications. Even though the OS gets access to the robust Play Store, support for most apps doesn't exist.



Screenshot of a recent build of Chrome OS